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Board of Education Report

File #: Rep-003-25/26, **Version:** 1

Agenda Date: 8/26/2025

In Control: Human Resources

Ratification of Incentive Grant Awards to Los Angeles Unified School District (LAUSD)

Human Resources Division

Brief Description:

(Ratification of Incentive Grant Awards to Los Angeles Unified School District (LAUSD)). Staff recommends to ratify the acceptance of two grant awards from the Commission on Teacher Credentialing, totaling \$1,485,000 allocated as follows:

- **California Classified School Employee Teacher Credentialing Program**
 - o **Award amount:** \$960,000
 - o **Grant Term:** 2024-2026 School Years
- **Reading and Literacy Supplementary Authorization Incentive Grant Program (RLAA)**
 - o **Award Amount:** \$525,000
 - o **Grant Term:** 2024-2027 School Years

Staff further recommends that the Board authorize the Chief Procurement Officer and/or designee to execute professional services contracts with external partners, colleges and universities as necessary to support the implementation of the California Classified School Employee Teacher Credentialing Program. The RLAA grant will be administered through LAUSD's in-house, accredited program. No external partners, colleges, or universities are required or listed.

Action Proposed :

Ratify the acceptance of two grant awards from the Commission on Teacher Credentialing, totaling \$1,485,000 and authorize the Chief Procurement Officer and/or designee to execute professional services contracts with external partners, colleges and universities as necessary to support the implementation of the California Classified School Employee Teacher Credentialing Program. The RLAA grant will be administered through LAUSD's in-house, accredited program. No external partners, colleges, or universities are required or listed.

Background :

The California Classified School Employee Teacher Credentialing was established to help address the statewide teacher shortage by supporting Local Education Agencies (LEAs) in recruiting classified employees into teaching careers. The program provides financial assistance for participants' undergraduate education, teacher preparation, and credentialing as California certified teachers.

The District has been a recurring recipient of this grant, with awards received in 2017, 2022, 2023, and now in 2025. This current grant award of \$960,000 will support the District's **Building Our Own Staff as Teachers** program (**BOOST**) for the 2025-26 school year. Funding is expected to support up to 100 classified employees annually over a two-year period. Each participant may receive up to \$4,800 per year to cover tuition reimbursement and other education or credentialing-related expenses. Of this amount, \$4,500 is provided

directly to the employee as a living stipend with \$300 being allocated for administrative costs, professional development, and test preparation. Classified employees must apply through a competitive selection process. Once admitted, participants must remain in good standing as District employees, with annual validation of performance evaluations, attendance records, and principal/administrator endorsement for continued enrollment.

In its grant application, LAUSD included all of the Institutions of Higher Education (IHEs) with which it holds articulation agreements. These partnerships allow BOOST members to follow a streamlined, multi-year plan toward credentialing while minimizing redundant coursework. Participating institutions include: California State University Dominguez Hills, California State University Los Angeles, California State University Long Beach, California State University Northridge, and the District's Intern, Credentialing, and Added Authorization Program (iCAAP). These institutions do not receive direct funding from the grant. All funds are administered by the District and disbursed to employee and program support services.

Grant Title	Grant Number	Participants/ Year	Funding Per Participant	Annual Grant/ Year
Classified School Employee Teacher Credentialing	21C126	100 (SY 2024-2025)	\$4,800	\$480,000
Classified School Employee Teacher Credentialing	21C126	100 (SY 2025-2026)	\$4,800	\$480,000
TOTALS		100		\$960,000

The Reading and Literacy Supplementary Authorization Incentive Grant Program is a California state initiative aimed at expanding the pool of credentialed teachers with specialized expertise in reading and literacy instruction. This program provides funding to support credentialed teachers in obtaining a Reading and Literacy Added Authorization (RLAA) or a Reading and Literacy Leadership Specialist (RLLS) credential. Both credentials are issued through the Commission on Teaching Credentialing (CTC) and are designed to address the growing need for literacy-focused educators amid statewide efforts to improve student reading proficiency. RLAA equips educators with advanced skills in literacy instruction and intervention, assessment and data-driven decision making, and designing and implementing comprehensive reading programs. RLLS prepares educators to leadership roles in literacy, including coaching, curriculum development, and school-wide literacy initiatives. Through rigorous coursework aligned with CTC standards and a structured clinical practicum, candidates learn to use data to inform instruction, design targeted interventions, and implement comprehensive reading programs.

This \$525,000 RLAA incentive grant award will provide funding over a three-year period to help address the urgent need for educators with specialized knowledge and skills to support students with reading difficulties, including dyslexia. Currently, the RLAA program enrolls 45-50 candidates annually. With the new funding, enrollment capacity will increase up to 70 participants per year, supporting a total of 210 over the three-year period.

LAUSD's accredited [RLAA <https://www.lausd.org/Page/7722>](https://www.lausd.org/Page/7722) program equips credentialed teachers with the expertise to assess, instruct, and intervene using evidence-based literacy practices. Through rigorous

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coursework aligned with CTC standards and a structured clinical practicum, candidates learn to analyze student data to inform instruction, design targeted interventions, and implement comprehensive reading programs. This training ensures teachers are well-prepared to advance equitable literacy outcomes for diverse learners across Los Angeles Unified.

The RLAA Grant will provide funding for eligible teachers to pursue the added authorization, thereby strengthening the District's internal capacity to deliver high-quality, research-based literacy instruction.

Grant Title	Grant Number	Participants/Year	Funding Per Participant	Annual Grant/Year
Reading and Literacy Added Authorization (RLAA)	RL07	70 (SY 2024-2025)	\$2,500	\$175,000.00
	RL07	70 (SY 2025-2026)	\$2,500	\$175,000.00
	RL07	70 (SY 2026-2027)	\$2500	\$175,000.00
TOTALS		210		\$525,000.00

Expected Outcomes :

In alignment with Pillar1: Academic Excellence, of the District's Strategic Plan, the Human Resources Division will expand the capacity of the RLAA program to better serve educators working in LAUSD's school communities. This grant represents a strategic investment in building teacher capacity through high-quality professional development.

These grants will enhance LAUSD's teacher and administrator training to remain competitive in recruitment and retention, while strengthening dedicated pipelines of future educators committed to preparing students to be college-prepared, career-ready, and Ready for the World.

This initiative reinforces LAUSD's leadership in educator preparation and positions the District as a competitive force in the statewide effort to improve literacy outcomes and educational equity.

Board Options and Consequences :

Ratification of these grants will enable the District to partner with local universities to offer and support a range of credentialing and supplementary authorization programs, including opportunities for Classified employees seeking to become teachers. These partnerships are essential to expanding access to high-quality educator preparation and strengthening internal pipelines.

If the grants were not approved, the District would be unable to move forward with these university partnerships and we could lose the vital pipeline of well-prepared, highly qualified teachers and administrators. Without this support, the District would not be able to provide the same level of financial assistance and professional development to classified employees pursuing teaching careers. This would significantly hinder efforts to address teacher shortages in critical areas such as STEM, special education, bilingual education, physical education, and the Arts. This would result in fewer classified employees transitioning into certificated roles that directly support students in the classroom.

Ratification of this grant will allow the District to expand the RLAA program, making it accessible to educators serving at the elementary, middle school, and high school levels. With over 25,000 K-12 teachers in LAUSD, this grant provides a critical opportunity to increase the number of reading and literacy specialists, ensuring that our students are college-prepared, career-ready, and Ready for the World.

If the grants are not ratified, the District may face a continued shortage of educators with the Reading and Literacy Added Authorization due to the current program's limited capacity. Expanding access to this added authorization is essential to closing the achievement gap in reading and literacy. Ideally, all teachers would hold this authorization to ensure every student receives a high-quality, evidence-based literacy instruction.

Policy Implications :

This action does not change District policy.

Budget Impact :

The grant funds must be administered in accordance with all applicable state and local laws, regulations, and policies governing the use and accountability of public school funds, including, but not limited to, the Education Code of the State of California.

The grants will prove up to \$1,485,000 in additional funding to the District over the duration of the grant period.

The California Classified School Employees Teacher Credentialing Program does not require matching funds resulting in no budget impact.

As outlined by the California Department of Education, the District is responsible for meeting two matching fund requirements associated with the RLAA grant. The first is an in-kind contribution equivalent to the \$525,00 grant amount, which will be fulfilled through existing staff positions within the Division of Human Resources that support RLAA grant activities. The second requirement is a direct contribution of \$126,000 for books, supplies, and instructional materials for participating teachers. These costs will be covered through a combination of existing resources and the Educator Effectiveness Block Grant.

Student Impact:

Ratification of these grants will enable the District to expand its capacity to recruit, prepare, and support highly qualified teachers and administrators. This is especially critical in high-need areas, including special education, where credentialed teachers are essential to serving students with disabilities.

By investing in educator training and expanding the number of teachers with specialized credentials in reading and literacy, the District will strengthen instructional quality and improve academic outcomes for all students, thereby supporting education equity and closing achievement gaps.

Issues and Analysis :

The California Classified School Employee Teacher Credentialing Program supports the District's efforts to maintain a strong classified to certificated employee pipeline by offering financial assistance and mentorship to aspiring educators currently serving in classified roles. Through this grant selected participants will receive a living stipend of \$4,500 a year, which can be used to offset credentialing and education related expenses including tuition, textbooks, technology, testing fees, and transportation.

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LAUSD received funding through Round 7 of the grant, with a liquidation period ending June 30, 2028. As part of the grant compliance requirements, the District must submit annual reports each July detailing expenditures and participant data.

Attachments:

Attachment A - Grant Award Letter Classified School Employees Teacher Credentialing

Attachment B - Grant Award Letter Reading and Literacy Added Authorization (RLAA)

Submitted:

08/08/25

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RESPECTFULLY SUBMITTED,


ALBERTO M. CARVALHO
Superintendent

APPROVED & PRESENTED BY:


FRANCISCO J. SERRATO
Chief Human Resources Officer
Human Resources Division

REVIEWED BY:


DEVORA NAVERA REED
General Counsel

☒ Approved as to form.

APPROVED & PRESENTED BY:


KRISTEN K. MURPHY
Associate Superintendent
Talent & Labor Relations

REVIEWED BY:


KURT JOHN
Deputy Chief Financial Officer

☒ Approved as to budget impact statement.

**Commission on Teacher Credentialing**

1900 Capitol Ave Sacramento, CA 95811(916) 322-6253

Fax (916) 244-0750

<https://www.ctc.ca.gov/>

Office of the Executive Director

May 15, 2025

Francisco Serrato, Chief Human Resources Officer
Los Angeles Unified School District
333 S. Beaudry Avenue
Los Angeles, CA 90017

Notification of Intent to Fund

Reading and Literacy Supplementary Authorization Incentive Grant Program Number: RL07
Total Grant Award Amount: \$525,000.00

Dear Francisco Serrato,

The Commission on Teacher Credentialing (Commission) is pleased to notify you that Los Angeles Unified School District's application for a grant award pursuant to the *Reading and Literacy Supplementary Authorization Incentive Grant Program* has been approved for funding. Los Angeles Unified School District will be expected to implement this grant in accordance with the narrative, related activities, and timeframe described in your grant application.

Funds allocated for this grant must be encumbered by June 30, 2027, followed by a two-year liquidation period. The grant funds are intended to cover expenses incurred for this program as described in the grant application and are non-renewable. The grant funds must be administered in accordance with all provisions of state and local laws, regulations, and policies relating to the administration, use and accounting for public school funds, including, but not limited to, the Education Code of the State of California. The grant funds must be expended in accordance with the proposed budget provided in your grant application. Los Angeles Unified School District will be responsible for accounting for both the grant funds expenditures and the matching funds expenditures as indicated in the submitted budgets.

If Los Angeles Unified School District accepts this grant award and agrees to abide by the grant award terms and conditions as indicated in the Grant Award Agreement, please sign the first page of the Grant Award Agreement form using the DocuSign link that was sent to you within two weeks. In addition, please also complete and submit via DocuSign the attached STD 204 form. Please note that the Commission cannot release funds to Los Angeles Unified School District without having the appropriate STD 204 form on file. If you have any questions, please email ReadLitGrant@ctc.ca.gov.

Annual funds to grantees will be distributed in two total payments. The first payment will be ninety percent (90%) of the total grant award amount, and the second payment will be ten percent (10%) of the total grant award amount. The second payment will be provided to grantees after the program has satisfactorily submitted its annual data report to Commission staff.

Grantees do not need to wait to receive actual funds to begin the Reading and Literacy Grant activities as state fiscal processes may take some time to process the grant payment to the LEA. To be eligible for potential renewal of grant funding after 2025-26, the grantee will be expected to make appropriate yearly progress in implementing the Reading and Literacy Grant activities.

The initial annual data report will be due to the Commission on **July 11, 2025**. Further information on the outcomes reporting process will be provided at a later date. Grantees must participate in an evaluation to determine the success of the program near completion of all activities relating to this grant and the completed evaluation will be submitted to the Governor and the education policy and fiscal committees of the Assembly and Senate.

We look forward to working with Los Angeles Unified School District on this important effort to support educators in obtaining a Reading and Literacy Added Authorization and/or Reading and Literacy Leadership Specialist Credential.

Yours truly,

A handwritten signature in cursive script, reading "Mary Vixie Sandy".

Mary Vixie Sandy
Executive Director

**Commission on Teacher Credentialing**

651 Bannon Street, Suite 600 Sacramento, CA 95811

(916) 322-6253

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Office of the Executive Director

April 24, 2025

Dr. Francisco Serrato, Los Angeles Unified School District
333 South Beaudry Ave.
Los Angeles, CA 90017

Notification of Intent to Fund

Classified School Employees Teacher Credentialing Program

Grant Award Number: 21C126

Annual Number of Participant Slots Funded: 100

Total Grant Award Amount: \$960,000.00

Dear Dr. Francisco Serrato,

The Commission on Teacher Credentialing (Commission) is pleased to notify you that Los Angeles Unified School District's application for a grant award pursuant to the *Request for Proposals for a California Classified School Employee Teacher Credentialing Program* has been approved for funding. Los Angeles Unified School District will be expected to implement this grant in accordance with the narrative, related activities and timeframe described in your grant application.

Funds allocated for this grant must be encumbered by June 30, 2026, followed by a two-year liquidation period. The grant funds are intended to cover expenses incurred for this program as described in your grant application and are non-renewable. The grant funds must be administered in accordance with all provisions of state and local laws, regulations, and policies relating to the administration, use and accounting for public school funds, including, but not limited to, the Education Code of the State of California. The grant funds must be expended in accordance with the proposed budget provided in your grant application. Los Angeles Unified School District will be responsible for accounting for the grant funds expenditures as indicated in the submitted budgets.

Please note that the authorizing legislation does not require any payback on the part of participants who do not successfully complete the program, nor does it require any matching funds on the part of the grantees. Please also note that for many classified employees who cannot afford to participate in the traditional student teaching approach, connecting these employees with a local Commission-approved Intern program can be a viable way to assist program participants to complete their preparation while providing them the opportunity to continue earning a salary.



Commission on Teacher Credentialing

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Office of the Executive Director

If Los Angeles Unified School District accepts this grant award and agrees to abide by the grant award terms and conditions as indicated in the Grant Agreement, please sign the first page of the Grant Agreement form using the DocuSign link that was sent to you within two weeks. In addition, please also complete and submit via DocuSign the attached STD 204 form. Please note that the Commission cannot release funds to Los Angeles Unified School District without having the appropriate STD 204 form on file. If you have any questions, please email ClassifiedGrants@ctc.ca.gov.

Funds to grantees will be distributed in two total payments. The first payment will be ninety percent (90%) of the total grant award amount, and the second payment will be ten percent (10%) of the total grant award amount. The second payment will be provided to grantees after the program has completed its annual activities and submitted its report of outcomes. Grantees do not need wait to receive actual funds in order to begin the planned Classified Grant Program activities as state fiscal processes may take some time in order to process the payment to the LEA.

The initial annual data report will be due to the Commission on **July 11, 2025**. Further information on the outcomes reporting process will be provided at a later date. Grantees must participate in an evaluation to determine the success of the program near completion of all activities relating to this grant and the completed evaluation will be submitted to the Governor and the education policy and fiscal committees of the Assembly and Senate.

We look forward to working with Los Angeles Unified School District on this important effort to grow and develop your LEA's candidates to earn a California teaching credential and help provide additional qualified teachers for California public schools.

Yours truly,

Mary Vixie Sandy, Ed.D.

Executive Director

Commission on Teacher Credentialing